# Louisa County Water Authority
# Board of Directors
# January 11, 2023

MEMBERS PRESENT: Mr. Judson Foster, Chairman; Mr. Douglas Smith, Vice-Chairman; Mr. Robert Hardy; Mr. Durwood Willis; Mr. David Kies; Mr. Robert Morgan; Mr. Tom Filer

OTHERS PRESENT: Ms. Pam Baughman, General Manager; Mr. Kyle Eldridge, Assistant County Attorney; Mr. Hunter Martin, Water Operations Manager; Mr. Eric Purcell, Louisa County Board of Supervisors

## A. Call to Order

Chairman Foster called the meeting to order at 6:00 pm.

1. ADOPTION OF THE AGENDA

Chairman Foster asked if there were any changes or additions to the agenda. The General Manager asked to add a presentation, Mr. Eldridge will be updating the Board on the status of the Water Supply Emergency, plan / policy / ordinance. Mr. Smith made a motion to adopt the agenda as amended. Mr. Filer seconded the motion and carried 7-0.

## B. Presentations

Mr. Kyle Eldridge, Assistant County Attorney provided to the Board the process to be followed in developing an ordinance for Water Supply Emergencies. Mr. Eldridge and Ms. Baughman will work to develop an ordinance, bring it to the Authority Board for approval; then the ordinance will go before the Louisa County Board of Supervisors for approval and adoption.

## C. Citizen Information

## D. Consent Agenda

2. APPROVAL OF THE MINUTES:

A. DECEMBER 14, 2022 – REGULAR BUSINESS MEETING

3. TREASURER'S REPORT:

A. O & M REPORT / CAPITAL REVENUE & EXPENDITURE REPORT – DECEMBER 2022
B. APPROVAL OF DISBURSEMENTS – DECEMBER 2022
C. CONSTRUCTION FUND – DECEMBER 2022

The Board reviewed the Consent Agenda, including the Treasurer's Report. Upon completion of the review, Mr. Filer made a motion to approve the Consent Agenda and Treasurer's Report as presented. The motion was seconded by Mr. Hardy and carried 7-0.

## E. Old Business

4. UPDATE – JAMES RIVER WATER PROJECT

The James River Water Authority meeting scheduled for January 11, 2023, was cancelled. Nothing new to report.

5. NORTHEAST CREEK WATER TREATMENT PLANT – SLUDGE VAC-SYSTEM UPDATE

The engineers are finalizing the plans and will submit them to the Virginia Department of Health – Office of Drinking Water for review and approval. They are also coordinating with Sam Massie, Procurement Officer for the County of Louisa to make sure the advertising for the request for bidding meets the requirements for procurement.

6. ZION CROSSROADS WELL SYSTEM UPDATES

A. SPRING CREEK - #1 & #2 UPDATE

The Virginia Department of Health – Office of Drinking Water issued the waterworks construction permit on December 27, 2022. Material will be delivered this week. Apex Electrical has been acquiring the needed electrical materials and backup generator. Apex Electrical and Central Virginia Contractors will be coordinating to finalize the project in the coming months. Apex Electrical has provided the cost to install the generator $144,600.

B. POORE WELL IMPROVEMENTS UPDATE

River City Water Solutions has indicated they will be onsite Friday, January 13, 2023, to repair the leak and install the filtering system.

C. ZION CROSSROADS DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM HYDRAULIC STUDY UPDATE

The General Manager provided the Board with an updated copy of the Distribution System Hydraulic Study. Upon completion of the Board's review, they authorized the General Manager to send the report to the Virginia Department of Health – Office of Drinking Water for inclusion in the Zion Crossroads Water Operations Permit.

7. REGIONAL WWTP PERMIT RENEWAL AND PROCESS OPERATIONS STUDY

Nothing new to report.

8. ZION CROSSROADS WWTP DIESEL TANK ADDITION FOR GENERATOR

The General Manager asked the Board for guidance on how to proceed with this project. Mr. Foster provided a contact for an additional quote for concrete work, Mr. Chris Botto. Mr. Botto indicated that he felt the concrete slab cost would come in at $10,000 - $15,000. With the tank cost at $10,600, the project can not be completed for $15,000.

The Board discussed different options and decided to go back to the original quote from Advanced Fueling Systems, Inc. Mr. Filer made a motion to authorize the General Manager to have the May 2022 quote updated and proceed at a cost not to exceed $38,000. The motion failed due to no one seconding the motion.

After further discussion, Mr. Smith made a motion to authorize the General Manager to proceed with an updated quote at a cost not to exceed $45,000. The motion was seconded by Mr. Morgan. Further discussion ensued and the Board directed the General Manager to have any unnecessary items removed from the quote. The motion carried 7-0 among the members present.

9. NEW TRUCK PURCHASE; SNOWPLOW AND 100-GALLON DIESEL TRANSFER TANK

Amy has reached out to the dealership we have dealt with through the state procurement website. The quote received for a truck without the safety light on the top of the cab is $48,050. To have the dealership add the light was quoted at $2,300, taking the vehicle purchase over the approved purchase price of $50,000 by $350. We have reached out to the company in Fluvanna, East Coast Emergency Vehicles, their quote was $3,358., taking the purchase price over the approved purchase prove of $50,000, by $1,408.

Upon completion of the discussion, Mr. Filer authorized the General Manager to proceed with the truck purchase at a cost not to exceed $50,350. The motion was seconded by Mr. Smith and carried 7-0 among the members present.

10. OPEN POSITIONS

A. MAINTENANCE TECH
B. WASTEWATER TRAINEE OR OPERATOR
C. OFFICE ASSISTANT – PART-TIME

The General Manager informed the Board that the three open positions were readvertised this week. As of the meeting, three applications have been received for the office assistant part-time position.

11. UPDATE – LAKE ANNA ENVIRONMENTAL WWTP

The General Manager informed the Board that the Board of Supervisors will be considering a resolution to purchase parcels 18 1 1B and 18 1 1A from Lake Anna Environmental Services on January 17, 2022. Authority staff will be meeting with the Department of Environmental Quality to go over information and timelines included in the draft permit to ensure we understand the contents.

12. UPDATE – CLEAR WELL ROOF / BASEMENT FLOOR DRAINAGE

Our quote from the supplier's technical department is still currently in process. That should be nearing completion and being sent sometime this week.

A couple of names of contractors have been provided to reach out to for a full quote, as the supplier does not provide labor. The contractors provided will be able to give you an estimate of full turn-key costs. We have reached out to the contractors to have them conduct a site visit. I would reach out to these guys soon and get them in for a job walk.

13. UPDATE – NANOFILTRATION GRATING EVALUATION / UPGRADE TO ACCESS / PALLET JACK

A structural engineer with Dewberry Engineers will be performing an evaluation of the back grating within the Nanofiltration building to ensure they will be able to handle the weight of a pallet jack and pallets of chemicals / materials. Barton & Boyd has provided an updated quote to correct the slope, compact the soil and repave the access site for chemical deliveries to the loading dock on the lower level of the original Northeast Creek Water Treatment Plant and the quote has been approved. The slope excavation and compaction will proceed with asphalt being installed when weather permits.

14. UPDATE – NORTHEAST CREEK DAM (SOUTH ANNA #22) AND BOWLERS MILL DAM (SOUTH ANNA #2)

All documents have now been submitted to the Department of Conservation and Recreation to bring the paperwork and requirements up to date for both the Northeast Creek Reservoir Dam (South Anna #22) and the Bowlers Mill Reservoir Dam (South Anna #2). All associated fees will be paid in the January 15, 2023, check run. All associated fees for Bowlers Mill will be billed for reimbursement to the County of Louisa.

15. UPDATE – LADDER FOR THE MAINTENANCE SHOP

The mezzanine ladder for the Maintenance shop has been ordered and will be installed upon receipt.

**F. New Business**

16. DISCUSSION – BUDGET

The General Manager asked the Board for some guidance as she begins to build the budget for FY2024. The Board directed the General Manager to start with the assumption that there will be no rate increases, however if it looks as though revenues will fall short of expenses to bring an option that provides a balanced budget.

**G. Reports**

16. PROGRAM MANAGER'S REPORT

*Mr. Purcell left the meeting at 6:55 pm.*

**H. General Manager's Report**

●**December levels**: At the end of December 2022, the static well levels are down approximately 1.9 feet from the end of November 2022 levels. From December 2021 to December 2022, the well levels are down approximately 10.75 feet.

The smaller table shows static well levels located nearer to the production wells. These levels are down approximately 2 feet from the end of November 2022 levels. From December 2021 to December 2022, the well levels are down approximately 30 feet.

As of January 5, 2023, for the Northern Piedmont Region, the Department of Environmental Quality Drought Monitor indicates normal conditions for precipitation, groundwater reservoir levels and streamflow.

● Included a Market Survey of Water and Sewer Authorities in or near Central Virginia.

● The 2023 legislative session convenes on January 11, 2023. This year is a short session that will adjourn on February 25, 2023.

**KEY DATES**

Jan. 11 – Session convenes, pre-filed bill introduction deadline
Jan. 13 – Budget amendment and bill drafting request deadline (5pm)
Jan. 20 – Last day to introduce legislation (3pm)
Feb. 5 – Money Committees to complete work on their Budget Bills
Feb. 7 – Crossover deadline; beginning Feb. 8 each house may only consider the other's bills
Feb. 15 – Each house to complete work on other house's Budget Bill and appoint conferees

1. The first bill pre-filed is a bill that will set limits for customer disconnections.

● The current past-due listing is down to $7,689.92 from the past-due listing provided in the General Manager's Report, which reported the past-due balance of $10,285.59.

● The Louisa County Water Authority business office will be closed on January 16, 2023, in observance of Martin Luther King, Jr. Day. All facilities will be manned as required.

● A safety video was shown to the Board that will be posted on our insurance company's website showing manlift safety training for operators and maintenance employees. Mary Johnson, Program Manager is shown discussing how the risk management grants offered by Virginia Risk Sharing Association helped the Authority get training for our staff. .

**I. Committees**

Mr. Foster asked if the rate review committee had met. Mr. Smith responded that they had not met yet.

Mr. Foster stated that the personnel committee had met on Tuesday, January 10, 2023, to begin work on the Employee Handbook review. The General Manager and the Program Manager will begin collaborating on the Employee Handbook, with the Committee focusing on a minimum starting wage, position levels, cola /merit increases and bonuses vs. increases.

**J. Short Notice Items**

**K. Closed Session**

**Next meeting date -** The next business meeting is scheduled for February 8, 2023.

**L. Adjournment**

THERE BEING NO FURTHER BUSINESS, Mr. Hardy made a motion to adjourn at 7:07 pm. The motion was seconded by Mr. Filer and carried 7-0.

BY ORDER OF:

Judson Foster
Chairman
LOUISA COUNTY WATER AUTHORITY